

Elasticity Card Sort

Cut down the dashed line for two sets. Each group ranks the cards MOST → LEAST elastic.

> cut

SET 1

A Coffee	B Buying a new car
C Your electric bill	D Eating out at a restaurant
E Gas this week	F A flight home for break
G Soda	H Cigarettes or vapes

SET 2

A Coffee	B Buying a new car
C Your electric bill	D Eating out at a restaurant
E Gas this week	F A flight home for break
G Soda	H Cigarettes or vapes

How research actually ranks them

Estimates are approximate and vary by study and time frame.

1	Eating out at a restaurant (card D)	$ Ed \approx 1.6$	ELASTIC
2	A flight home for break (card F)	$ Ed \approx 1.5$	ELASTIC
3	Buying a new car (card B)	$ Ed \approx 1.3$	ELASTIC
4	Soda (card G)	$ Ed \approx 0.8$	INELASTIC (borderline)
5	Cigarettes or vapes (card H)	$ Ed \approx 0.4$	INELASTIC
6	Coffee (card A)	$ Ed \approx 0.25$	INELASTIC
7	Gas this week (card E)	$ Ed \approx 0.25$	INELASTIC
8	Your electric bill (card C)	$ Ed \approx 0.13$	INELASTIC

Teaching point: notice how many everyday goods land in the inelastic zone — the big flinch is rarer than students expect. It also depends on how narrowly you define the good: “soda” is inelastic-ish, but “one brand of soda” is very elastic.